HCD & Lean Side-by-Side

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	HCD	Lean
Core Question	"Are we solving the **right problem(s)**?"	"How might we **remove waste** from this process?"
Primary Audience(s)	**Human-Centered** (e.g. clients, staff, broader community)	**Customer-Centered** (e.g. direct clients of a service)
Primary Evidence-Base	**Qualitative Data** Surfacing the lived experience of the people affected by a process/program	**Quantitative Data** The existing process and how work actually flows today
Key Methods	**Listen, Learn, Make** Empathy interviews, observation, ideation, prototyping	**PDCA (Plan - Do - Check - Act)** Value stream mapping, root cause analysis
Success Looks Like	A solution people actually want and use	A process that is faster, cleaner, less wasteful
Risks if Applied Alone	The process can produce a beloved solution that doesn't scale or operationalize.	Creating an efficient process that still doesn't serve the customer's real need.
What they Both Share	Both are **iterative** and **continuous** processes. You don't apply these approaches once and then stop; you keep returning to improve.	

Putting These Approaches into Practice

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Instructions. Consider where you see opportunities to utilize **one <u>or</u> both** of these approaches (HCD and/or Lean) in your own context. Brainstorm activities or mindsets that you might start, stop, and continue to put this into practice.

	HCD	Lean
START *What could you start doing to bring HCD or Lean into your work?*		
STOP *What's getting in the way - a process, habit, or assumption - that you could stop doing?*		
CONTINUE *What's working that you should keep doing or further invest in?*		